

Topic 3: State and Education

OBJECTIVES

- Paraphrasing and summary writing

READING FOUR: The "Banking" Concept of Education

Warm-up

What is education for?

Read the statements below. Think about your experience with the education system that you have been in (either in Thailand or any other countries). Do you agree or disagree with these statements? Check the boxes below and be ready to explain your opinion.

Statements	Opinions			Reason / Evidence
	Agree	Disagree	Not Sure	
1. A good student is someone who listens quietly and follows instructions.			✓	
2. The teacher is the only source of knowledge in the classroom.		✓		
3. The goal of education system is to maintain the existing social order.			✓	
4. Teachers and schools know what is important for the students.			✓	
5. Learning facts is more important than thinking critically.		✓		
6. Teachers' job is to mold students into skilled labors feeding the country's workforce.	✓			
7. Education should help students question the world.	✓			
8. Students should be active participants in the learning process.	✓			

Brainstorm

1. From the above statements and discussion with your classmates, try to define the difference between "passive" learning and "active" learning.
2. Which groups of people do you think benefit from each type of education system? Why?

Pre-reading: Vocabulary

Here is a list of academic vocabulary that you will encounter in this text. Check to see how many of them you already know. Put a check mark next to the ones you know and try to explain the words to your friends.

narrative	empirical	static	expound	detached
alienated	verbosity	annul	credulity	marginal
pathology	dehumanize	domestication	irreconcilable	vocation
ontological	indoctrinating	pursuit	inherit	espouse
Paradoxical	praxis	abandon	docile	supersede

Instead of memorizing random words one by one, it is easier to learn vocabulary by connecting related words together. This helps your brain remember more easily and use the words more naturally when you speak or write. In this case, since we are reading a text under the theme of education, we can group the words into (1) what teachers do, (2) how students feel, and (3) how the content is being described.

With a partner, read each word from the table and write the words in the chart below to organize them. If you're not sure about a word, use the dictionary or ask a classmate! The first ten words have been done for you.

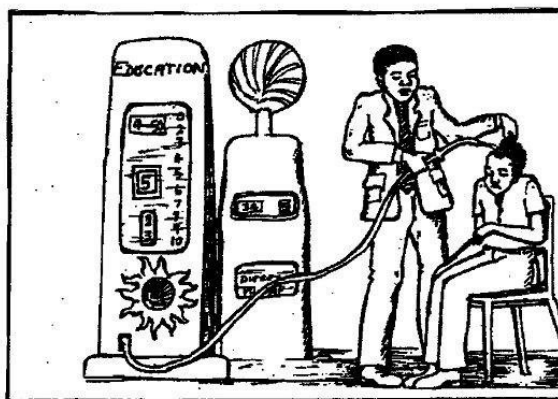
Teacher	Students	Content
expound annul	alienated credulity marginal	narrative empirical static detached verbosity

When you understand how the words relate, you'll remember and use them more confidently!

Pre-Reading: Predicting and Anticipating

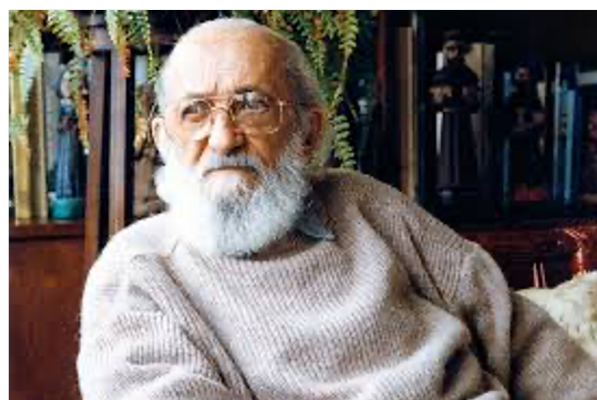
You are going to read a text which discusses a relationship between teachers, students, and the environment in which education takes place.

In small groups, look at each of these pictures below and discuss what messages they are trying to communicate.



Discuss the following questions:

1. What do you think the 'banking concept of education' might mean? In this model, how do you think the teacher, students, knowledge, and learning would be represented?
2. In his essay, Freire compares the banking model of education to an alternative model of education. Who do you think Freire was writing this essay for? What could be his goal in writing this article?



Paulo Freire (1921 – 1997) was a Marxist Brazilian educator and philosopher who was a leading advocate of critical pedagogy.

Reading

Written by Paulo Freire, this essay "The "Banking" Concept of Education," was adapted from his book *Pedagogy of the Oppressed* published in 1970. In small groups of THREE, take turn to read aloud the essay "The "Banking" Concept of Education," one paragraph at a time. Then, answer the comprehension questions for each paragraph.

The "Banking" Concept of Education

- 1 A careful analysis of the teacher-student relationship at any level, inside or outside the school, reveals its fundamentally **narrative** character. This relationship involves a **narrating subject** (**the teacher**) and **patient, listening objects** (**the students**). **The contents**, whether it be values or **empirical** dimensions of reality, **tend in the process of being narrated to become lifeless and petrified**. Education is suffering from narration sickness.
- 2 The teacher talks about reality as if it were motionless, **static**, compartmentalized, and predictable. Or else he **expounds** on a topic completely alien to the existential experience of the students. His task is to **"fill" the students with the contents of his narration**— contents which are **detached** from reality, **disconnected from the totality that engendered them and could give them significance**. Words are emptied of their concreteness and become a hollow, **alienated**, and alienating **verbosity**. **This is the "banking" concept of education**, in which **the scope of action allowed to the students extends only as far as receiving, filing, and storing the deposits**.
- 3 **The capability of banking education to minimize or annul the students' creative power and to stimulate their credulity serves the interests of the oppressors**, who care neither to have the world revealed nor to see it transformed. Thus, **they react almost instinctively against any experiment in education which stimulates the critical faculties and is not content with a partial view of reality but always seeks out the ties which link one point to another and one problem to another**.
- 4 Indeed, **the interests of the oppressors lie in "changing the consciousness of the oppressed, not the situation which oppresses them"; for the more the oppressed can adapt to that situation, the more easily they can be dominated**. **To achieve this end, the oppressors treated oppressed individuals as marginal persons who deviate from the general configuration of a "good, organized, and just" society**. **The oppressed are regarded as the pathology of the healthy society, which must therefore adjust these "incompetent and lazy" folk to its own patterns by changing their mentality**. **These marginals need to be "integrated," "incorporated" into the healthy society that they have "forsaken."**
- 5 **Teachers who use the banking approach**, knowingly or unknowingly (for there are innumerable well-intentioned bank-clerk teachers who do not realize that **they are serving only to dehumanize**), fail to perceive that the deposits themselves contain contradictions about reality. But, sooner or later, **these contradictions may lead formerly passive students to turn against their domestication and the attempt to domesticate reality**. They may discover through existential experience that their present way of life is **irreconcilable** with their **vocation** to become fully human. They may perceive through their relations with reality that reality is really a process, undergoing constant transformation. If men and women are searchers and their **ontological** vocation is humanization, **sooner or later they**

may perceive the contradiction in which banking education seeks to maintain them, and then engage themselves in the struggle for their liberation.

- 6 Education as the exercise of domination stimulates the credulity of students, with the ideological intent (often not perceived by educators) of indoctrinating them to adapt to the world of oppression. This accusation is not made in the naive hope that the dominant elites will thereby simply abandon the practice. Its objective is to call the attention of true humanists to the fact that they cannot use banking educational methods in the pursuit of liberation, for they would only negate that very pursuit. Nor may a revolutionary society inherit these methods from an oppressor society, as the revolutionary society which practices banking education is either misguided or mistrusting of people.
- 7 Unfortunately, even those who espouse the cause of liberation are themselves surrounded and influenced by the climate which generates the banking concept, and often do not perceive its true significance or its dehumanizing power. Paradoxically, then, they utilize this same instrument of alienation in what they consider an effort to liberate. Authentic liberation—the process of humanization—is not another deposit to be made in men. Liberation is a praxis: the action and reflection of men and women upon their world in order to transform it.
- 8 Those truly committed to liberation must reject the banking concept in its entirety. They must abandon the educational goal of deposit-making and replace it with the posing of the problems of human beings in their relations with the world. "Problem-posing" education responds to the essence of consciousness—intentionality. The teacher is no longer merely the-one-who-teaches, but one who is himself taught in dialogue with the students, who in turn while being taught also teach. They become jointly responsible for a process in which all grow. The students—no longer docile listeners—are now critical co-investigators in dialogue with the teacher. The teacher presents the material to the students for their consideration and re-considers her earlier considerations as the students express their own. The role of the problem-posing educator is to create; together with the students, the conditions under which fixed knowledge is superseded by emerging dialogic knowledge.
- 9 Education as the practice of freedom—as opposed to education as the practice of domination— recognizes that humans are conscious beings who engage with the world around them. This approach emphasizes dialogue, critical thinking, and the understanding that both the world and human consciousness are dynamic and interconnected. Through this process, education becomes a practice of freedom, a means by which people can reflect on their world and work together to transform it.

COMPREHENSION: Identifying main Ideas

Paragraph 1

1. How does the author describe the process of traditional education, and what does it result in?

Paragraph 2

2. According to the author, what are the two problems with how teachers treat “reality” in the banking concept of education?

3. What is the impact of this approach on the students?

Paragraph 3

4. How does the "banking" concept of education serve the interests of oppressors?

5. According to the text, what are the two “experiment in education” the oppressors are instinctively against?

Paragraph 4

6. According to the author, how do the oppressors control the consciousness of the oppressed?

Paragraph 5

7. What will eventually happen to the students in the banking approach to education?

8. What will these students’ response be as a result?

Paragraph 6

9. What is the author's goal in pointing out that banking educational methods is a system of indoctrination?

Paragraph 7

10. What is the author's main message to those who espouse the cause of liberation?

Paragraph 8

11. How does the role of the teacher and student change in problem-posing education?

Paragraph 9

12. According to the author, how can education become a practice of freedom?

POST-READING: Activity and discussion

1. Which ONE sentence from the reading "*The "Banking" Concept of Education*" that is the most memorable to you? Explain your reasons to your partners.
2. Think about your own school experience. Was it more like the "banking" approach or the "problem-posing" approach? Which one would you like to have more of in the future? What can teachers and students do to make that happen?
3. What do you think Freire means when he says education can be used to support or challenge unfair systems in society? Can you think of any examples from your own experience or what you've seen? Do you agree with this idea? Why or why not?
4. Work in groups of 3–4. Draw a picture that shows the "problem-posing" way of learning from the article. Then, give a short talk (2–3 minutes) to your classmates. Explain your picture and how it shows the idea of "problem-posing" education.

LANGUAGE IN FOCUS: Paraphrasing

It can be easy to spot when someone has copied directly from a textbook. We all have different styles of writing and yours will be different to the authors you are reading.

To paraphrase is to rewrite something using different words without changing the original meaning. This is what is usually meant by the phrase 'in your own words'. The paraphrase should be clearer and more easily understood than the original and is often about the same length. Paraphrases are a good alternative to using direct quotations.

A paraphrased text should be significantly different from the original source, without changing the meaning. Effective paraphrasing is a key academic skill needed to avoid the risk of plagiarism: it demonstrates your understanding of a source.

Paraphrasing and summarising are normally used together in essay writing, but while summarising aims to **reduce** information to a suitable length, paraphrasing attempts to **restate** the relevant information.

Note that an effective paraphrase usually:

- has a different structure to the original
- has mainly different vocabulary
- retains the same meaning
- keeps some phrases from the original that are in common use e.g. 'industrial revolution' or 'eighteenth century'

Do remember that even when you paraphrase someone's work you must acknowledge it.

Example

Original

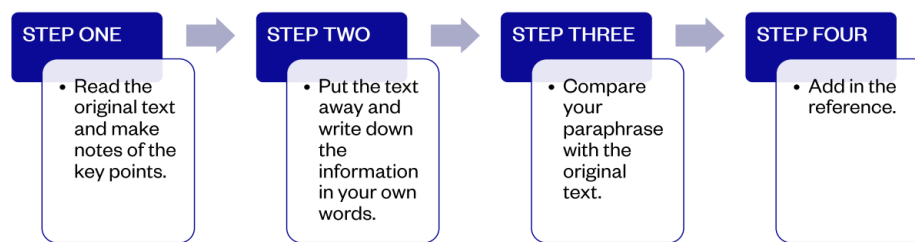
The mere physical proximity of one person to another is a potent facilitator of attraction (Martin *et al.*, 2007: 757).

Paraphrase

Attraction between two people is greatly influenced by their physical close- ness (Martin *et al.*, 2007).

Original	Paraphrase
Physical proximity	Physical closeness
Of one person to another	Between two people
X is a potent facilitator of Y	Y is greatly influenced by X
'Physical proximity' is the subject of the sentence	'Attraction' is the subject of the sentence

How do you paraphrase?



Paraphrasing techniques

1. Use synonyms or alternative phrases. You do not need to change specialized vocabulary.
 - asserts – *claims, argues, maintains*
 - twentieth century – *1900s*
 - illustrates – *explains, emphasizes, clarifies*
2. Change word class.
 - analyze – *analysis, analyzing*
 - create – *creating, creation*
 - assume – *assumption, assuming, assumed*
3. Change the sentence structure.
 - From NP → clause
 - Use participial phrases
 - Change voice

It is important to use several techniques in order to successfully paraphrase someone else's ideas. If your paraphrase is too similar to the original text, it may result in accidental plagiarism.

More example

Original

In recent years a body of research has revealed another, more nuanced benefit of workplace diversity: nonhomogenous teams are simply smarter. Working with people who are different from you may challenge your brain to overcome its stale ways of thinking and sharpen its performance.

(from – Rock, D. & Grant, H. (2016). Why diverse teams are smarter. *Harvard Business Review*)

A bad paraphrase

In the *last few* years, a *collection* of research has shown another, more nuanced *advantage* of workplace diversity: diverse teams are simply *better*. Working with

people who are **unlike** you may **encourage** your brain to **lose** its **old ways** of thinking and **improve** its performance.

Note: This paraphrase has only replaced some words with synonyms and has kept the structure almost identical to the original sentence.

A good paraphrase

Recent research has revealed that working in diverse teams can stimulate your creativity and efficiency, advocating the benefits of workplace diversity (Rock & Grant, 2016).

Note: This paraphrase shows a change in sentence structure and words

Practice

Read the quotes from the reading. Write a paraphrase for each quote. Discuss your answers with a partner.

1. "The teacher talks about reality as if it were motionless, static, compartmentalized, and predictable. Or else he expounds on a topic completely alien to the existential experience of the students." (paragraph 2)

Paraphrase: _____

2. "Indeed, the interests of the oppressors lie in "changing the consciousness of the oppressed, not the situation which oppresses them"; for the more the oppressed can be led to adapt to that situation, the more easily they can be dominated." (paragraph 3)

Paraphrase: _____

3. "They may discover through existential experience that their present way of life is irreconcilable with their vocation to become fully human." (paragraph 5)

Paraphrase: _____

4. "Paradoxically, then, they utilize this same instrument of alienation in what they consider an effort to liberate." (paragraph 7)

Paraphrase: _____

5. "Those truly committed to liberation must reject the banking concept in its entirety. They must abandon the educational goal of deposit-making and replace it with the posing of the problems of human beings in their relations with the world." (*paragraph 8*)

Paraphrase: _____

READING FIVE: It's time to rethink education

Warm-up

On a piece of paper, write down your personal response to the following questions:

1. What does "academic success" mean to you?
2. How do you know when you're being successful in school?
3. Has your definition of success ever caused you stress or pressure? How have you dealt with that pressure?

In small groups, share 1–2 ideas from your reflection with your classmates. Explore what you have in common. In what ways do people around you (family, teachers, society) influence this shared idea of success? What can we do to maintain your well-being while pursuing your definition of academic success?

Pre-reading: Vocabulary

Match each word with the correct definition. Draw a line or write the matching letter next to the word.

- | | |
|--------------------|---|
| 1. fetch | A. A strong request or appeal for something. |
| 2. utilitarian | B. A very direct and forceful way of trying to persuade someone to buy something. |
| 3. faulty | C. Afraid of or showing dislike for people from other countries. |
| 4. hard sell | D. Common or widespread at a particular time or place. |
| 5. striving | E. Designed to be useful rather than attractive or fancy. |
| 6. xenophobic | F. Great mental or physical pain. |
| 7. commodification | G. Going and bringing something back. |
| 8. prevalent | H. Happening again and again over a long time; persistent. |
| 9. chronic | I. Having mistakes or not working properly. |

- | | |
|------------------|--|
| 10. idle | J. Not active or not doing anything productive. |
| 11. nurturing | K. Organized in levels of importance or authority. |
| 12. plea | L. Providing care and support to help someone grow and develop. |
| 13. torment | M. The process of turning something into a product to be bought or sold. |
| 14. hierarchical | N. Trying very hard to achieve something. |

Pre-reading: Making predictions

Read the title and subtitle of the article “It’s Time to Rethink Education” and skim through the opening paragraph.

It’s Time to Rethink Education

The existing system is giving birth to an unhappy generation with aggression, fear and psychic stress

AVIJIT PATHAK

The Tribune India, Jul 10, 2024

As a columnist on education issues, I often ask myself why I continue to write on this topic. Personally, it is difficult for me to give my consent to what society regards as ‘education’. If you go by the dominant common sense of the age, education primarily means three things: (a) it is some sort of ‘training’ or a mode of ‘skill learning’ – the skills the market demands or the skills that fetch one a job; (b) education is a kind of graded learning one passes through, or it is a way through which one becomes an ‘expert’ in some sort of specialised academic knowledge; and (c) it transforms one into a ‘resource’ that can be used for economic, militaristic, technological purposes. But then, I am not comfortable with this utilitarian approach to education. The reason is that if education fails to activate our humanistic sensibilities, it remains faulty and dangerous, even if it produces the ‘skilled’ labour force for enhancing the ‘growth rate’ of the nation, trains ‘resource persons’ for strengthening the techno-militaristic state and manufactures thousands of research papers in order to hardsell ‘top-ranking’ colleges or universities.

In groups, predict:

1. What might the writer’s feel when writing this article?
2. What problems might the article be talking about?

Reading

Read the article “It’s Time to Rethink Education” by Avijit Pathak. Highlight the main ideas and underline the major details of each paragraph. Complete the tasks that follow.

It’s Time to Rethink Education

The existing system is giving birth to an unhappy generation with aggression, fear and psychic stress

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The Tribune India, Jul 10, 2024

- As a columnist on education issues, I often ask myself why I continue to write on this topic. Personally, it is difficult for me to give my consent to what society regards as ‘education’. If you go by the dominant common sense of the age, education primarily means three things: (a) it is some sort of ‘training’ or a mode of ‘skill learning’ – the skills the market demands or the skills that fetch one a job; (b) education is a kind of graded learning one passes through, or it is a way through which one becomes an ‘expert’ in some sort of specialised academic knowledge; and (c) it transforms one into a ‘resource’ that can be used for economic, militaristic, technological purposes. But then, I am not comfortable with this utilitarian approach to education. The reason is that if education fails to activate our humanistic sensibilities, it remains faulty and dangerous, even if it produces the ‘skilled’ labour force for enhancing the ‘growth rate’ of the nation, trains ‘resource persons’ for strengthening the techno-militaristic state and manufactures thousands of research papers in order to hardsell ‘top-ranking’ colleges or universities.
- Without any hesitation, I am saying that this kind of instrumental education has proved to be completely incapable of imagining and striving for a new world free from militarism, environmental disaster, xenophobic nationalism, religious fundamentalism and utter commodification of life. These days, we have an abundance of experts and specialists without a conscience, technology without soul, market without ethics and human ‘resources’ devoid of inner richness and higher ideals. In a way, the prevalent practice of education transforms a young learner into a reckless warrior; it is giving birth to an unhappy generation with aggression, chronic restlessness, fear, psychic stress and spiritual dumbness.
- In this context, let me recall some of the forgotten ideals of education. For instance, sensitivity, Jiddu Krishnamurti repeatedly emphasised, is the highest form of intelligence – sensitivity to life or sensitivity to nature. Krishnamurti used to urge young students to watch the amazing sunset with absolute mindfulness and meditateness. It is not idle daydreaming; it is not a waste of time; it is not a temporary relief from physics and mathematics. Instead, it is about becoming

alert, developing awakened intelligence and nurturing a self that relates compassionately to the world. In a way, this spiritual dimension of education can also be seen in Rabindranath Tagore's critique of oppressive school culture; and his plea for the development of artistic sensibilities of the young learner.

- 4 In addition, I often draw inspiration from American feminist scholar Bell Hooks. When she was alive, she continually inspired her students with a beautiful blend of critical pedagogy and ethic of care. Education, as she demonstrated through her teaching and writing, should cultivate the capacity to love and heal the world tormented by all sorts of violence. But then, think of our collective decay, our fall. As parents and teachers, we are advising this generation only to think of their careers – their salary packages. We are asking them to run like mad horses and not to think of others – their pain, trauma and suffering. What we regard as education these days seems to be only reproducing the ideology of a violent hierarchical exploitative society.
- 5 And finally, I recall distinguished political theorist and philosopher Martha Nussbaum's reminder: "Not everything is for profit; democracy needs humanities." As Nussbaum argues, it is like thinking that the primary goal of education is to teach students to be economically productive rather than to think critically and become knowledgeable, productive and empathetic individuals. This sort of one-sided focus on 'profitable skills', says Nussbaum, is eroding our ability to criticise authority and reducing our sympathy with the marginalised. Looking beyond the act of reducing education to a tool of the gross national product, Nussbaum wants to reconnect education to the humanities in order to encourage students to be true democratic citizens.
- 6 It is indeed high time we began to rethink education. If education is not saved from the virus of market fundamentalism, we will cause severe damage to the mental health of the new generation. We will not be forgiven for this crime.

COMPREHENSION: Identifying main Ideas

Arrange these topics in the correct order based on the article.

- _____ a) The importance of humanities for democracy
- _____ b) The author's call to action
- _____ c) Education with care and compassion
- _____ d) The author's concern with modern education
- _____ e) Spiritual purposes of education
- _____ f) The consequences of utilitarian education

Answer the following questions to check your understanding.**Paragraph 1**

1. What is the author's main concern about how society currently defines education?

2. What are the three common ways education is defined in today's society?

3. Why is the author uncomfortable with this utilitarian view of education?

Paragraph 2

4. According to the author, what is the result of an education system that only focuses on skills and productivity?

5. What kind of people does this system create?

Paragraph 3

6. What educational value does the author highlight through Krishnamurti's ideas?

Paragraph 4

7. What does bell hooks teach us about how education should support students and society?

Paragraph 5

8. What is Martha Nussbaum's argument about the purpose of education?

Paragraph 6

9. What is the author's final message or warning about the future of education?

10. What's the overall message that the author tried to convey in this article?

POST-READING: Activity and discussion

1. Which ONE sentence from the reading “*It’s Time to Rethink Education*” that is the most memorable to you? Explain your reasons to your partners.
2. Do you agree with the author’s criticism of education being mainly focused on job training and profit? Why or why not?

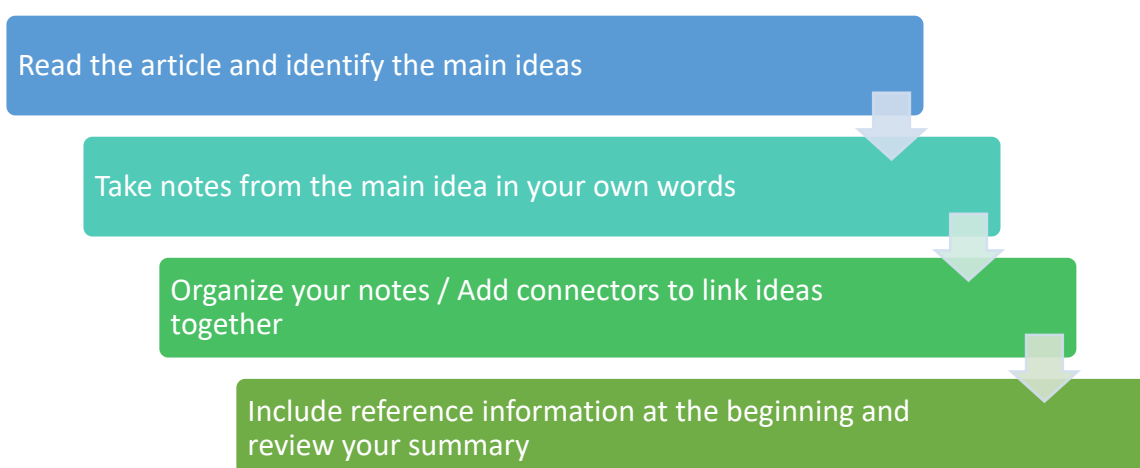
LANGUAGE IN FOCUS: Summarizing

We have mentioned before that paraphrasing and summarizing are normally used together in essay writing. We learned that paraphrasing is an act of restating the information in your own words, and summarizing is to **reduce** information to a suitable length.

A summary is like a paraphrase in that we are expressing someone else’s ideas in our own words and we are giving credit to the original author. It is unlike a paraphrase in that it is taken from a larger body of work. A paraphrase comes from an idea or two, or a sentence or two, that someone else has originated. A summary, however, can be derived from an article, a chapter of a book, or even an entire book. In summarizing something we often have to restate the author’s original ideas; therefore, paraphrasing is part of summarizing.

Summarizing is a perfect way to share with others what we have read. It is also an excellent way to record our understanding of a reading passage. While it is true that AI can easily does the summarizing, it cannot help you process the material in a way that is meaningful to you. If we can clearly write a summary of a story or article, it is obvious that we have clearly interpreted and understood it.

Here’s how you summarize:



Structure of a summary:

Like most academic writing, a summary has an introduction, a body, and a conclusion.

The **introduction** of the summary must contain the **kind** (that is, an article, a report, a book), the **title**, and the **author** of the written material. In that way, the audience knows what is being summarized and where the material originated. Following are examples of summary beginnings. Notice that the first one refers to an article in a magazine, a journal, or a newspaper; the second, to a chapter of a book; the third, to a report; the fourth, to an article whose author is unknown.

1. Jeffrey Pfeiffer, in his article "The Ambiguity of Leadership", (states / explains / says / argues) that ...
2. In the seventh chapter of his book **Psychology**, author Charles G. Morris (states / explains / says / argues) that ...
3. According to Gilbert Cauts in his report entitled "Working Conditions and their Effects on Employees," (+ Main point / Controlling idea of the text) ...
4. The author of "Barriers to Communication" (states / says / explains / argues) that ...

The rest of the introductory sentence should be as brief and to the point as possible. It should contain the main point or the controlling idea of the original text. This is very important since the purpose of this first sentence is to give the reader a quick overview of the entire text. Even when the development in the original text is inductive, the controlling idea should appear in the first sentence of a summary. Look at the examples below.

1. In an article entitled "Your Money or Your Life?", Achara Deboonme describes the reasons why the middle classes turn to private hospitals.
2. In Elizabeth Hoddy's article "Atom Bombs or Basic Needs?", she presents India's perception of its new status as a nuclear power.

The **body** of a summary contains the main ideas of the article in the same order that they appeared in the original. You should not simply copy the words, phrases, and sentences of the author of the article. Instead, you must use your own sentences to summarize (although some of the words will, of course, be the same as those in the article). In order to use your own sentences and vocabulary, rather than copying the words and phrases from the original article, you might use just your notes – not the article itself – to write the rough draft of your summary. Then refer to the article as you revise your first draft. In addition, it is important for the reader of the summary to understand that the information the summary writer is presenting comes from the original source. Therefore, you may sometimes refer to the author of the original material in the body of the summary. Possible phrases include

According to Hoffer, ...

Ms. Gregory believes that ...

Hertzberg describes ...

The author presents

The **conclusion** of the summary should briefly relate the conclusion of the author of the original article. In the same way as you have summarized the rest of the article, the conclusion should not contain your judgements or conclusions.

Exercise

Read the following summary and do the tasks that follow.

In Sophronia Scott Gregory's article, "Teaching Young Fathers the Ropes," she describes the program helping unmarried black fathers learn the skills they need for fatherhood. According to Ms. Gregory, new programs like the Responsive Fathers Program in Philadelphia help young unmarried men become better fathers, providers and mates through counseling services and job preparation. The article explains that the program, sponsored by Public and Private Ventures, believes in long-term solutions. Because so many black children grow up without fathers, the program targets unemployed young black males. For three to six years, participants work to become responsible, self-sufficient productive citizens.

1. Circle the words indicating the kind of the original material, the title, and the author.
2. Underline the main point or the controlling idea of the original material.
3. Circle the phrase referring to the author of the original material in the body of the summary.
4. Underline the conclusion of the summary.

Practice

In the space below, write a summary of the article "*It's Time to Rethink Education*". The summary should be between 120-150 words in length.

REVISION: VOCABULARY

Complete the essay with the highlighted words from the readings of Topic 3 (State and Education). Use the synonym in parentheses to help you select the correct word or phrase.

Whose Interests Does Education Serve?

In many modern societies, the role of the state in education is a topic of intense debate. Some argue that schools should exist primarily to (1) _____ (support / develop) critical thinking and democratic values in students. Others contend that education systems too often serve to (2) _____ (brainwash) young minds with a fixed set of political or ideological beliefs, leaving little room for independent thought.

This tension is especially visible in countries where state influence over the curriculum is strong. In such environments, students are expected to remain (3) _____ (submissive), obediently absorbing knowledge without questioning its foundations. This approach not only discourages creativity but also risks producing a (4) _____ (fixed) view of society—one that ignores change, complexity, and contradiction.

Furthermore, education policies often fail to address the needs of (5) _____ (excluded / underrepresented) groups, such as ethnic minorities or students from low-income backgrounds. These learners may be excluded from full participation in the system, either directly or indirectly, leading to long-term disadvantages that can gradually (6) _____ (diminish) their opportunities for social mobility.

One of the most (7) _____ (common) trends in recent years has been the emphasis on measurable outcomes and standardized testing. While these methods are often justified as being based on objective data, critics warn that a heavy reliance on (8) _____ (data-driven / observable) evidence can reduce education to a narrow set of quantifiable skills, ignoring the broader humanistic purposes of learning.
